

Sales and Business Development English Dialogue Lab

Realistic field-specific dialogues, role-play variations, and observer checklists

Audience: account executives, business-development representatives, sales managers, partnership teams, solutions consultants, channel managers, and revenue leaders

Focus: A sales and business development English curriculum for discovery, qualification, objection handling, pricing, procurement, enterprise buying committees, negotiation, partnership language, and CRM discipline.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Dialogue Practice Method

Read each exchange once for meaning, once for tone, and once for decision structure. Then complete the missing language by selecting one of four options and check the rationale at the end.

1. Discovery and Qualification

Setting

A prospect asks for a demo before explaining their problem.

Speaker	Line
Account executive	Show the full demo immediately.
Prospect	Pain, priority, authority, timeline, and business impact need qualification.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm discovery, qualification, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Account executive	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short discovery call plan. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: discovery, qualification.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects qualification.

Option	Phrase
A	discovery
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Show the full demo immediately.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify discovery and qualification against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A prospect asks for a demo before explaining their problem. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the discovery call plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	evidence threshold

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

2. Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit

Setting

A prospect likes the product but cannot name a use case.

Speaker	Line
Solutions consultant	Push for next steps anyway.
Account executive	Use case, stakeholder value, success metric, and urgency need definition.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm value proposition, use case, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Solutions consultant	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short value mapping note. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: value proposition, use case.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects use case.

Option	Phrase
A	use case
B	success metric
C	value proposition

Option	Phrase
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Push for next steps anyway.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A value mapping note is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	evidence threshold
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify value proposition and use case against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A prospect likes the product but cannot name a use case. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the value mapping note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	operating constraint

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

3. Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure

Setting

A prospect says a competitor is cheaper.

Speaker	Line
Sales manager	Discount immediately.
Prospect	Total value, risk, scope, implementation, and commercial terms need comparison.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm objection, competitor, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Sales manager	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short competitive objection response. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: objection, competitor.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects competitor.

Option	Phrase
A	objection
B	decision owner
C	competitor
D	differentiator

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Discount immediately.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify objection and competitor against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	A competitive objection response is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A prospect says a competitor is cheaper. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the competitive objection response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	evidence threshold

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

4. Pricing, Discounting, and Approval

Setting

Procurement demands a last-minute discount.

Speaker	Line
Account executive	Approve it to close the quarter.
Revenue operations	Pricing policy, margin, term length, volume, and approval path must be reviewed.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm discount, procurement, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Account executive	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short discount approval request. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: discount, procurement.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice**1. Complete the field language**

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects procurement.

Option	Phrase
A	discount
B	evidence threshold
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Approve it to close the quarter.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify discount and procurement against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Procurement demands a last-minute discount. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	evidence threshold
C	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the discount approval request with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

5. Enterprise Buying Committees

Setting

A champion says the deal is done but legal has not reviewed it.

Speaker	Line
Sales director	Forecast the deal as committed.
Account executive	Decision criteria, legal, security, finance, and executive sponsor status matter.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm champion, economic buyer, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Sales director	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short deal-risk update. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: champion, economic buyer.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects economic buyer.

Option	Phrase
A	champion
B	economic buyer
C	buying committee
D	forecast category

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Forecast the deal as committed.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify champion and economic buyer against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	evidence threshold

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A champion says the deal is done but legal has not reviewed it. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the deal-risk update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

6. Negotiation and Contract Redlines

Setting

A customer requests unlimited liability in the contract.

Speaker	Line
Account executive	Agree because it is a strategic deal.
Legal counsel	Risk allocation, legal approval, insurance, and business value need decision.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm redline, liability, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Account executive	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short redline escalation. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: redline, liability.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects liability.

Option	Phrase
A	commercial term
B	redline
C	liability
D	indemnity

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Agree because it is a strategic deal.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A redline escalation is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify redline and liability against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve redline after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A customer requests unlimited liability in the contract. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the redline escalation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

7. Partnerships and Channel Development

Setting

A potential partner wants exclusivity before proving pipeline.

Speaker	Line
Business-development lead	Grant exclusivity to secure the relationship.

Speaker	Line
Partner	Territory, targets, enablement, economics, and performance gates need clarity.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm channel partner, exclusivity, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Business-development lead	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short partner term outline. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: channel partner, exclusivity.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects exclusivity.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	channel partner
C	pipeline
D	enablement

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Grant exclusivity to secure the relationship.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify channel partner and exclusivity against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve channel partner after the result is visible.
D	A partner term outline is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A potential partner wants exclusivity before proving pipeline. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the partner term outline with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Option	Phrase
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

8. CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews

Setting

A rep keeps stale opportunities in late stages.

Speaker	Line
Sales manager	Leave them because the pipeline looks stronger.
Account executive	Next step, close date, buyer evidence, and risk should drive forecast accuracy.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm CRM, pipeline, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Sales manager	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short pipeline inspection notes. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: CRM, pipeline.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Three-step decision practice

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects pipeline.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	CRM
C	commit
D	slippage

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Leave them because the pipeline looks stronger.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
B	I understand the urgency. I need to verify CRM and pipeline against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
C	We should act now and resolve CRM after the result is visible.
D	A pipeline inspection notes is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A rep keeps stale opportunities in late stages. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the pipeline inspection notes with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	evidence threshold
C	approval path
D	operating constraint

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Discovery and Qualification - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. discovery	'discovery' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Discovery and Qualification - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify discovery and qualification against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Discovery and Qualification - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the discovery call plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. value proposition	'value proposition' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify value proposition and use case against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the value mapping note with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. objection	'objection' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify objection and competitor against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the competitive objection response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Pricing, Discounting, and Approval - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. discount	'discount' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Pricing, Discounting, and Approval - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify discount and procurement against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Pricing, Discounting, and Approval - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the discount approval request with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Enterprise Buying Committees - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. champion	'champion' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Enterprise Buying Committees - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify champion and economic buyer against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Enterprise Buying Committees - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the deal-risk update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Negotiation and Contract Redlines - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. redline	'redline' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Negotiation and Contract Redlines - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify redline and liability against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Negotiation and Contract Redlines - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the redline escalation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Partnerships and Channel Development - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. channel partner	'channel partner' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Partnerships and Channel Development - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify channel partner and exclusivity against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Partnerships and Channel Development - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the partner term outline with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. CRM	'CRM' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. I understand the urgency. I need to verify CRM and pipeline against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the pipeline inspection notes with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.